

10 out-of-the-box life upgrades for men that cost less than \$100

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Aug 15, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/NP5JEkLp0Js> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter runs through ten practical, low-cost purchases and habits — spanning nutrition tracking, fitness, sleep, productivity, and style — designed to meaningfully upgrade a man's daily life for roughly \$100 or less.

Contents

- 🍽️ Upgrade 1: Food Scale
- 👟 Upgrade 2: Walking Shoes & Daily Steps
- 🥗 Upgrade 3: Meal Prep Delivery Service
- 💊 Upgrade 4: Creatine Monohydrate
- 💧 Upgrade 5: Large Water Bottle
- 🌑 Upgrade 6: Blackout Curtains
- 📓 Upgrade 7: Cheap Notebook
- 🤖 Upgrade 8: ChatGPT Pro Subscription
- 👕 Upgrade 9: Fitted Black T-Shirts
- ⌚ Upgrade 10: Fitbit (Budget Fitness Tracker)

Upgrade 1: Food Scale 0:00

- Purpose: track your macros accurately
 - Brandon's blunt framing: so you can "finally stop being a fat boy"
- Removes guesswork from portion sizes, making diet adherence far more reliable

Upgrade 2: Walking Shoes & Daily Steps 0:00

- Invest in a good pair of walking shoes
- Target: **10,000–20,000 steps per day**
 - Low-impact, sustainable way to increase daily calorie burn and cardiovascular health

Upgrade 3: Meal Prep Delivery Service 0:00

- A service that delivers healthy, pre-prepped food weekly
- Acknowledged caveat: costs more than \$100
 - However, the net cost argument is that you save on:
 - Grocery bills
 - Time spent traveling to and shopping at the store
 - Time spent cooking
 - Time spent doing dishes
 - Brandon's claim: "you'll end up saving way more than you spend" when all time and money are factored in

Upgrade 4: Creatine Monohydrate 0:23

- Specific form recommended: **creatine monohydrate**
- Advice: take it every day
- Notable point: benefits extend beyond gym performance
 - "Even if you don't work out, it's good for your brain health and your mental health"
- One of the most evidence-backed, affordable supplements available

Upgrade 5: Large Water Bottle 0:23

- Buy a **huge water bottle** so hydration becomes effortless
 - Eliminates the need to consciously track or count glasses of water
 - Makes hitting **over a gallon of water per day** straightforward

Upgrade 6: Blackout Curtains 0:23

- Install blackout curtains to improve sleep quality
- Rationale: "you're not going to be out here hustling and grinding if you're tired"
 - Sleep is framed as a direct performance and productivity input

Upgrade 7: Cheap Notebook 0:46

- Keep a notebook on you at all times
 - Use it to capture ideas as they arise
 - Use it to record everything you need to remember
- Low cost, high utility — no specific brand required

Upgrade 8: ChatGPT Pro Subscription 0:46

- Brandon calls it "Chad GBT Pro"

- Use case: automate the "grunt work" in your life
 - Saves significant time on repetitive or low-value tasks
- Positioned as a productivity multiplier worth the monthly subscription cost

Upgrade 9: Fitted Black T-Shirts 0:46

- Buy a pack of **fitted black t-shirts**
- Preferred style: **V-neck variety**
- Simple, affordable wardrobe upgrade that improves appearance and eliminates daily outfit decision fatigue

Upgrade 10: Fitbit (Budget Fitness Tracker) 0:46

- Recommended device: **Fitbit Air** at approximately **\$100**
- Positioned as the best budget alternative to premium trackers
 - Premium alternatives mentioned: Whoop, Oura Ring
 - Advice: "If you can't afford a Whoop or an Oura ring, this is the best option"